EN.02.01 ICT Project Management

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1. General

The following definitions apply throughout this document:

Term	Definition
ICT Project	A structured, time-bound initiative in the field of information technology, undertaken to deliver a unique product, service, or outcome. An ICT project has a clearly defined start and end date, specific objectives, and assigned resources. Such projects may involve developing new systems, enhancing existing ones, improving business processes, introducing new operational capabilities, building or upgrading infrastructure, applying new technology, or modernizing enterprise applications.
Application Development	The end-to-end process of designing, building, testing, and deploying software applications to meet business needs. This can include creating entirely new applications, extending the functionality of existing software, or integrating different systems to support operational, regulatory, or customer requirements.

The purpose of this document is to describe the ICT project management lifecycle at Trade Republic, from initial planning to continuous improvement, defining the roles, responsibilities, and ownership at each stage. It also explains how these responsibilities are realised using relevant tools and templates.

The lifecycle and guidelines described here apply to a wide range of ICT projects at Trade Republic, including but not limited to:

- Mobile iOS and Android applications
- Web applications
- Backoffice tools
- Backend services, applications, and infrastructure

2. Risk Management Framework

Trade Republic has established a Risk Management Framework to ensure that all areas of operations are organised under the same overarching principles and standards. This Risk Management Framework applies to all subordinated work instructions as well.

Core element of the overall setup of the operation of Trade Republic is the concept of Three Lines of Defense:

1. The **First Line of Defense (1LoD)** is responsible for all operational risks and controls. This applies to the identification, recording, the reporting and the management of the risk. Furthermore, the FLoD needs to ensure that appropriate controls and assessments are established in order to mitigate these risks. The majority of the staff members of Trade Republic belong to the First Line of Defense.
2. The **Second Line of Defense (2LoD)** oversees the activities of the First Line of Defense and supports the implementation of adequate and effective Risk Management which reflects the risk appetite of Trade Republic. The 2LoD is independent of the FLoD.
3. Audit forms the **Third Line of Defense (3LoD)** and ensures on an independent basis that the operational risks of Trade Republic are effectively managed.

3. Responsibilities

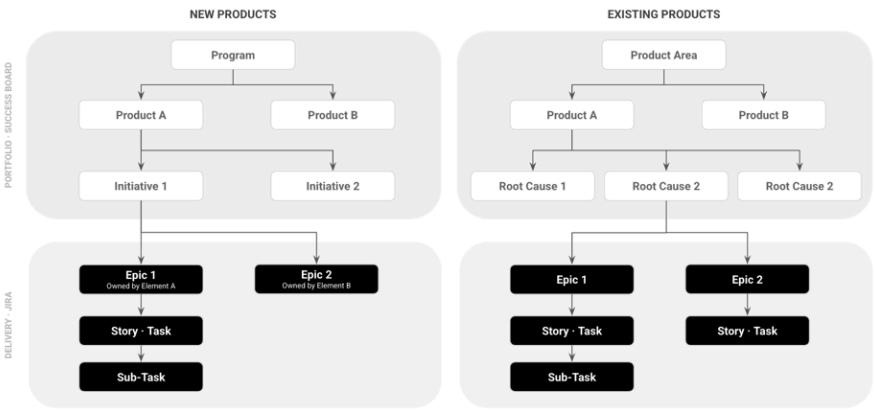
Role	Description
Managing Director Front Office & Managing Director Back Office	Define the long-term vision of the company and approve company-level strategic goals.
Head of Product	Own the company-wide product roadmap, ensure strategic alignment across Elements, and drive prioritization and visibility through Success Board and relevant delivery forums. Endorses the outcome of the ICT Project risk assessment where needed.
Director of Engineering	Oversee engineering strategy and execution across all Elements, ensure delivery alignment with company priorities, and support the resolution of cross-team dependencies, risks, and capacity constraints. Participate in delivery forums to provide engineering leadership and unblock initiatives. Endorses the outcome of the ICT Project risk assessment where needed.
Element Product Owners	Own and maintain the roadmap for their Element, ensure alignment with company priorities, and update delivery progress in the Success Board as part of weekly element delivery reviews. Determine whether an initiative meets the ICT Project trigger criteria and, where triggered, complete the ICT Project risk questionnaire directly in the PRD/RFC during Discovery.
Element Tech Leads	Support roadmap execution by validating technical feasibility, surfacing risks, and ensuring engineering standards are met.
Product & Engineering & Design Leads	Collaborate during discovery to shape requirements, assess usability, value, and feasibility, and ensure designs and specifications meet business and technical needs.
Engineers	Deliver development work, contribute to backlog refinement, and participate in relevant ceremonies to ensure timely and high-quality delivery.
Epic Lead	Own and coordinate the end-to-end delivery of the epic. Responsible for creating and maintaining epic-level tickets, organising discovery and refinement sessions, aligning cross-functional stakeholders, and tracking delivery progress through to completion.

4. Activities

4.1 How Work is Structured

Work is organised across two layers. Portfolio artefacts describe what we are building and why, at a strategic level, and are held in Success Board. Delivery artefacts describe how the work is built and are managed by teams in Jira. Product leadership owns the portfolio above the epic, and engineering owns the epic and everything below it.

Delivery is tracked in two views. **New Products** covers launches still ahead of us, such as market localisations and new product launches, and monitors whether we are on track to deliver on time. **Existing Products** covers the current product, sliced into mostly customer-facing parts, and monitors operational health through signals such as ticket volume, complaint counts, and defined health indicators. The two views use different portfolio hierarchies, shown side by side below.



The hierarchy nests one level to many below it. A Program holds several Initiatives and an Initiative several Epics. Each item has exactly one parent. A Product Requirements Document can sit at more than one level, framing strategic intent at Program level and defining specific deliverables at Epic level. Any strategic work carries a PRD at the level appropriate to it before it enters delivery.

Work enters the delivery cycle through prioritisation against company strategy, available capacity, and business impact. Inputs are consolidated from company goals set during quarterly and annual planning, strategic investments that improve the technical and operational foundations, and external requirements arising from legal, regulatory, or compliance obligations. Programs and Products are set by Product leadership, and Product Owners break that intent into deliverable work as Initiatives for new products or as Epics mapped to the relevant Root Cause for existing products.

4.2 Delivery Cycle

Our project delivery cycle consists of four stages:

- **Product Discovery**, where we confirm the problem, value, and readiness before work begins (defining the "what" and "why");
- **Technical Discovery**, where the solution is designed and the plan to build to is approved/aligned on;
- **Delivery**, where the team iteratively builds and refines the solution; and
- **Verification**, where we validate the outcome against the success metrics.



The four stages, their exit gates, and their ownership are summarised below. **R** is the role Responsible for driving the stage. **A** is the role Accountable for its outcome.

#	Stage	Exit gate	Responsible (R)	Accountable (A)
0	**Product Discovery**	PRD is ready, Kick-off Meeting took place	Product Owner	Product Owner
1	**Technical Discovery**	RFC and tickets ready	Epic Lead	Tech Lead
2	**Delivery**	Code, review, and QA	Epic Lead	Product Owner
3	**Verification**	Outcome validated	Epic Lead	Product Owner

The cycle is iterative, not linear. Findings during Technical Discovery can send work back to the PRD in Product Discovery, and learnings during Delivery can loop back into Technical Discovery.

4.2.1 Product Discovery

Product Discovery confirms that an initiative is ready to enter the cycle. The focus is on establishing the problem, the value, and how success will be validated, so that the team commits only to work that is worth doing and ready to start. It validates two of the three readiness questions: Usability, is the solution usable for the target audience, and Value, does it deliver measurable value to the customer and the business.

This phase ends with a live kick-off session where the goal is to establish a shared understanding of the “what” and “why,” align stakeholders, and set up the framework for effective collaboration and communication.



Activities	Description	Owner
Product Requirements Document (PRD)	• Clearly describe the current state, future state, business value, and validation. • Acts as the single source of truth for all team members and stakeholders. Sits at Program, Initiative or Epic level as appropriate.	Product Owner
Kick-off Meeting	• Present the PRD. • Align on goals, priorities, and timelines. • Clarify roles, responsibilities, and expectations.	Product Owner

Stage Gate Criteria – To move from Product Discovery to Technical Discovery

- PRD completed and accessible to all relevant stakeholders.
- Usability and value validated at a level sufficient to commit the team.
- Scope is validated by the Tech Lead and team
- The team is genuinely available to start.

Best Practices

- Validate the problem with real customer or business evidence before committing.
- Define measurable success metrics in the PRD, so Verification has something concrete to check against.
- Keep the Kick-off meeting focused and time-bound.
- Document all decisions in a central location (Confluence/Jira).
- Ensure cross-functional representation to avoid later rework.

4.2.2 Technical Discovery

Technical Discovery reduces risk before production code. It builds on a clear PRD: Product defines the problem and its edge cases, Engineering defines the solution, and the two develop together as understanding sharpens. Technical Discovery confirms the remaining readiness question: Feasibility - can it be built with the available resources and capabilities within acceptable timelines?

The phase produces an approved RFC or Spec, refined tickets, a design snapshot, optional ADRs, and a Slack channel, with the plan covering interfaces, data, quality and safety, and rollout and rollback before build begins. Findings here may send the team back to the PRD, and that is expected.



Activities	Description	Owner
Ownership	• Name one Epic Lead per Epic.	Product Owner/Tech Lead
Epic Team Refinement	• Ensure high-level user stories are created at the epic level. • Update the PRD as new information emerges.	Epic Lead
RFC	• Document “what” (requirements from user stories) and “how” (technical design). • Highlight dependencies, risks, and required cross-team contributions.	Epic Lead, Tech Lead
Delivery Kick-off Meeting	• Review RFC and refined tickets with the team. • Invite relevant roles (Product, Engineering, Design, Legal & Compliance, etc.) based on scope and impact.	Epic Lead
Follow-up	• Create a public Slack channel (#team-[atom]-[epic]) for collaboration. • Add the PRD to the channel bookmarks.	Epic Lead
New Product Process (NPP)	• Initiate NPP to ensure the involvement, approval, and sign-off from other relevant business departments (e.g., IT Operations, Information Security, Internal Audit, Marketing). • A full list of required business areas are explicitly listed here: NPP Template V.5.3 (valid for all NPPs starting Oct 2026) Archived.	Product Owner
Material Change Process (MCP)	• If the initiative involves changes to organisational structure or IT systems that qualify as material under MaRisk (AT 8.1 and 8.2), initiate MCP immediately after Kick-off. • Use this template: MCP Template V.3 (valid for all MCPs starting Jan 2026) Archived	Product Owner

Best Practices

Stage Gate Criteria – To move from Technical Discovery to Delivery

- RFC documented and shared with relevant stakeholders.
- PRD updated to reflect agreed scope and objectives.
- All tickets required for the first delivery increment refined and estimated.
- One Epic Lead named per Epic.
- Key risks identified and mitigation plans outlined.

- Maintain clear and open communication channels with all stakeholders.
- Validate early and often - through prototypes, mockups, or data analysis.
- Keep scope flexible enough to adapt if new information emerges.
- Use Discovery to break work into deliverable increments, enabling early value delivery.

4.2.2.1 ICT Project Trigger Criteria

An initiative is an **ICT Project** - and therefore subject to the risk assessment in Section 4.2.2.2 - if **Question 1 OR Question 2** below is Yes. There is no separate third gate.

Question 1 - The Process Trigger: Does this initiative require or trigger a formal New Product Process (NPP) or Material Change Process (MCP)?

Question 2 - The Impact Trigger: Does this initiative do any of the following to a system or process supporting a Critical and Important Function (CIF)/Critical Path (CP)? A "Yes" to any one item below, even without triggering an NPP/MCP, is sufficient.

Trigger	Test
a. Swap / replace	The product, platform, or tool running a CIF/CP system or process changes to a different one, not a version upgrade. Vendor swaps only count if the vendor is a critical ICT third party (same test as trigger d) - not a peripheral-feature vendor.
b. Migrate	Migrates production data, workloads, or infrastructure for that system to a new platform, provider, or architecture.
c. Redesign	Fundamentally redesigns any ONE of the 5 key control categories below as they apply to a CIF/CP. Routine operation of an existing control does not count - only a change to the control mechanism, provider, or architecture itself: • Identity & Access Management (authentication method, SSO/identity provider, MFA requirement, or PAM model); • Cryptography & Key Management (encryption scheme, or the key-management system/HSM/KMS provider); • Network & Perimeter Security (network segmentation architecture, or firewall/WAF platform); • Backup & Recovery (backup strategy or tooling/provider); • Business Continuity/Disaster Recovery (failover/redundancy architecture, or DR site/strategy).
d. New critical third party	Onboards a new, or materially changes an existing, critical ICT third party delivering a capability the CIF/CP depends on.
e. Cross-functional, dedicated effort	Requires **all three** of: (i) sustained for more than one quarter (3 months); (ii) spans more than one product or engineering domain (cross-functional, not one team's routine work); (iii) a dedicated team commitment for that period, not a single engineer's part-time or incidental contribution.

Not a trigger - exclusion guidance (replaces the former BAU-filter question). The following are explicitly out of scope for Question 2, to keep the assessment fast and prevent it from capturing routine delivery:

- Version upgrades, patches, or configuration changes to the existing system or vendor.
- New features or UX changes built on existing architecture.
- Scaling, capacity, or performance tuning without a platform or vendor swap.
- Vendor contract renewals with no functional or technical change.
- Standard BAU sprint work and routine version bumps (handled via existing Change Management / Jira-PR review).

The CIF register and Critical ICT Third-Party inventory used in triggers (a), (c), and (d) are maintained and provided by the ICT Risk Control Function (2nd Line). Product Owners check against these lists rather than making their own criticality judgment call.
2026 Critical or Important Functions (CIFs)

Mosaic Overview of CIF supporting ICT Services

4.2.2.2 ICT Project Risk Assessment

Performed once, at PRD/RFC Technical Discovery, for every initiative where Question 1 or Question 2 (Section 4.2.2.1) is Yes, before implementation kickoff (Delivery, Section 4.2.3). **This checklist and questionnaire are completed directly inside the initiative's PRD and RFC**, not as a separate document.

The assessment is framed around project execution risk (*what can go wrong delivering this*, not just the end-state system), since that is what a Product Owner can actually assess and own at initiation. Each dimension is scored with 3 fixed Yes/No questions instead of an open judgment call, so the outcome doesn't depend on who fills it in.

Scoring rule (same for every dimension):

- 0 "Yes" answers = **Low**
- 1 "Yes" = **Medium**
- 2–3 "Yes" = **High**
- **Overall Risk Rating = the highest single rating across the six dimensions** (one High anywhere = High overall). No averaging or weighting - kept deliberately simple to stay auditable and fast.

Dimension	Standardised questions - answer Yes/No	Rating	Mitigation owner / target date
Schedule / delivery	Delivery depends on more than one team or external delivery to hit the critical path. Go-live date is fixed by an external/regulatory deadline with no flexibility. The plan has less than 2 weeks of schedule buffer.	High/Medium/Low	to be defined by the Product Owner
Third-party / vendor delivery *(mark all No if no third party involved)*	Involves a new or unproven vendor (no track record with TR). The vendor's deliverable sits on the critical path with no fallback if delayed. The contract has no SLA/penalty terms for late delivery.	High/Medium/Low	to be defined by the Product Owner
Scope / execution complexity	Requirements are not yet final (PRD not signed off) at kickoff. The change spans more than 2 teams or systems. First time the team has built this type of capability.	High/Medium/Low	to be defined by the Product Owner
Staffing / resourcing	Delivery depends on a single named individual with no backup. The team is not fully staffed for this initiative (open critical roles). Relies on contractors/external staff with no knowledge-transfer plan.	High/Medium/Low	to be defined by the Product Owner
Cutover / rollback	No tested rollback or fallback procedure exists. Cutover requires a live-traffic switch (no parallel run/shadow period). A cutover issue would be customer-visible or disrupt the CIF/CP.	High/Medium/Low	to be defined by the Product Owner
Data & security	Involves migrating or transforming production data. Changes authentication, access control, or key management. Expands the attack surface (new integration/external endpoint).	High/Medium/Low	to be defined by the Product Owner

Sign-off: Head of Product + Director of Engineering endorse the assessment of the Product Owner. Any dimension rated Medium or High requires a named mitigation owner and target date, tracked through Delivery (Section 4.2.3).

4.2.2.3 Reporting & Escalation

Satisfies DORA RTS Art. 15(5): CIF/CP-impacting ICT projects and their risks are reported to the management body individually or in aggregation, periodically and on an event-driven basis. No new meetings are created - risk status is carried into the existing weekly Architecture Review and Delivery Review forums.

Scenario	Overall rating	Action
CIF/CP-impacting (Question 2 = Yes)	High	Escalate individually to the Information Security Committee (ISC), event-driven, in addition to the standing item in Architecture Review/Delivery Review.
CIF/CP-impacting (Question 2 = Yes)	Medium / Low	Included in periodic (quarterly) aggregated ISC reporting; standing item in Architecture Review/Delivery Review.
Not CIF/CP-impacting (Question 1-only, non-CIF/CP product)	N/A	Documented in PRD only - no ISC reporting required.

At closure (Section 4.2.4 Verification), residual risk and open action items are recorded back into the PRD/RFC and retained in tracker or minutes as audit evidence.

4.2.3 Delivery

Delivery is the execution phase, where the team iteratively develops, tests, and deploys the agreed scope, ensuring quality and alignment with business objectives.



Activities	Description	Owner
Atom Refinement	• Align product and engineering priorities. • Ensure shared understanding of the work.	All Team Members
Functional Refinement	• Fully refine tickets for the next sprint.	Product Owner
Planning	• Balance feature work, technical improvements, and ad-hoc requests.	Product Owner
Progress Tracking	• Combine feature epic work, improvement epics, technical excellence, and ad-hoc requests. • Monitor delivery progress in Jira and Success Board. • Where the ICT Project risk assessment rated any dimension Medium or High, track the named mitigation owner and target date as part of progress tracking.	Product Owner, Epic Lead

Stage Gate Criteria – To move from Delivery to Verification

- All work for the release increment completed and tested.
- Release plan documented in the Project Page.
- NPP signed off (if required).
- On-call responsibility confirmed and 24/7 coverage assigned for the release period.

Best Practices

- Hold regular syncs to align across functions and teams.
- Showcase progress through demos.
- Keep the backlog groomed to enable smooth sprint transitions.
- Confirm the on-call setup before release to ensure rapid response to production issues. Refer to the On-Call Confluence page for coverage details.

Note: There's often natural overlap between the **Discovery** and **Delivery** phases. Insights from discovery (like refined requirements or new learnings) may feed into delivery before all discovery work concludes.

This aligns with the principles of **dual-track agile**, where discovery and delivery run in parallel to accelerate iteration and validation.

Change Management and Testing

All changes in ICT projects follow the formal Change Management Framework (EN.01) to ensure traceability, risk control, and approval before production deployment.

- Changes are initiated and tracked via Jira, linked to the relevant Epic.
- A 4-eyes review applies to all code merges in GitHub, preventing unapproved changes from being deployed.
- Production Readiness Approval confirms that required testing and reviews are completed before go-live.
- Evidence and sign-offs are recorded in Jira, GitHub, or Success Board.

Testing and Quality Assurance

Testing ensures that all ICT project deliverables meet functional, security, and performance requirements before release. Activities follow EN.02.03 Product Testing, EN.02.04 Automated Software Testing, and EN.03.01 Release Management.

- **Automated tests** (unit, integration, regression) run via **GitHub Actions** and **SonarQube**; any failed test blocks a merge.
- **Manual and regression testing (UAT)** is executed using Allure TestOps and tracked in Jira.
- **Coverage thresholds**: 80% quality gate on new code applied to all production repositories and is enforced in SonarQube.
- **Security and performance testing** are included for high-risk or material changes.
- A release proceeds only after meeting all **quality gates** and obtaining sign-off from the **Product Owner**, **Tech Lead**, and **Information Security** (for high-risk projects).
- Test evidence and approvals are stored in GitHub, Allure, or linked Jira tickets.

Bringing Features Live

Trade Republic uses a staged approach to launching features:

1. **Staged Release to Production** - Deploy to a controlled subset of users
2. **A/B Testing** - Compare control and variation performance
3. **Monitoring** - Track KPIs, system metrics, and logs
4. **Full Rollout & Marketing Push** - Launch to all users once success criteria are met

Security Expertise Integration

Information Security participates in project reviews via the NPP/MCP process and through involvement in Discovery and Delivery phases for projects with material or high-risk ICT impact.
Security-by-design principles are applied throughout, ensuring early identification of security requirements, review of technical designs, and validation through automated and manual testing before production deployment.

4.2.4 Verification

Verification confirms the outcome against the PRD success metrics. The rollout is monitored, variations are analysed, and the initiative is validated rather than merely shipped, before a decision is taken on next steps.



Activities	Description	Owner
Monitoring	• Track SLAs, system metrics, and error rates.	All Team Members
A/B Testing & Analysis	• Compare variations to validate improvements.	Product Owner
Enhancements	• Implement changes based on performance data and user feedback.	Epic Lead/ Team

Stage Gate Criteria - To close the initiative

Best Practices

- Outcome validated against the PRD success metrics.
- Post-launch review completed (typically ~30 days after go-live).
- Decision made to:
  - Move to maintenance,
  - Continue iterative improvements, or
  - Pivot significantly.

- Keep improvement cycles short to deliver value quickly.
- Share learnings and outcomes with stakeholders.
- Document changes for future reference and audits.

5. Controls

Controls overview:										
RCSA Control ID	Key Control? (Y / N)	Control Name	Status	Owner	Description	Evidence	System Used	Type	Automation	Frequency
C.ENG.0091	Yes	**Weekly Initiative Progress Review**	Active	Valentin Tribula	Stage gating of each initiative is reviewed and executed during the Programs and Delivery Reviews.	Success Board, Delivery Reviews	Success Board	Directive	Manual	Weekly
C.ENG.0092	Yes	**Confidential Project Access Restrictions**	Active	Valentin Tribula	For confidential projects, access is restricted to a need-to-know basis with use of code names in relevant tools (e.g. Success Board, Jira) that do not reveal critical information of their underlying projects.	Individual documentation	Jira, Confluence, Success Board	Preventive	Semi-automated	Weekly
C.ENG.0225	Yes	**ICT Project Risk Assessment & ISC Escalation**	Active	Valentin Tribula	ICT projects meeting the trigger criteria are risk-assessed by the Product Owner, reviewed by ICT Risk Control and signed off by the Head of Product and Director of Engineering before implementation. High-rated projects are escalated to the ISC.	Completed risk assessment, ISC escalation records for high-rated projects	Confluence, Jira	Preventive	Manual	Ad-hoc

6. Attachments

	Name	Link
1	Project Reporting & Governance	EN.02.02 ICT Project Reporting
2	Engineering On-Call	Engineering On-Call
3	NPP Template	NPP Template V.5.3 (valid for all NPPs starting Oct 2026) Archived
4	New Product Process	4. Product Catalogue
5	Material Change Policy (MCP)	7. Material Change Catalogue
6	MCP Template	MCP Template V.3 (valid for all MCPs starting Jan 2026) Archived
7	Material Changes	P.CR.08.01 Analysis of Material Changes in the Organisational Setup, the Process Organisation or IT Systems Archived
8	Change Management Framework	EN.01 Change Management
9	Product Testing	EN.02.03 Product Testing
10	Release Management	EN.03.01 Release Management
11	Product Requirements Document Template	PRD Template
12	Request for Comments Template	RFC Template

1 3	Architecture Decision Record Template	ADR Template